Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

August 2010 Volume 53, Number Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

August Monthly Meeting

at 7:00 pm in the Lakewood Park Building

Presentation on upcoming Flood Control Projects



President's Column

-Fred Fowler

August Meeting - Flood Control

Greetings neighbors. One of the problems we face in our little corner of Sunnyvale is flooding caused by storm water runoff. Back in 1997 when I was first elected to the Sunnyvale City Council the neighborhood's streets flooded several times because of large rain storms in the Santa Cruz mountains. Water would flow down the Calabazas Creek and the Sunnyvale East and West channels and would overflow their banks. Water would also come up through the storm drains because of defective "flap gate" valves linking those drains to the flood control channels

When I joined the City Council, one of my first inter-governmental assignments was to sit on a "flood control advisory committee" for the ***Santa Clara Valley Water District***. I spent almost 8 years on that committee and ended up becoming its chairman before I left public office. During that time I pressed hard for solutions to the flooding problems of our neighborhood and of other neighborhoods like ours.

One of the solutions was to find a way to pay for a great deal of "deferred maintenance" on the flood control system. In 2000, the Water District board of directors placed "*Measure B"* on the November ballot. It was a bond measure designed to finance a large number of projects to revamp and modernize a great deal of the flood control infrastructure in our valley. *Measure B* was put before the voters and required a 2/3 majority to be passed. It passed the 2/3 threshold by less than 200 votes! It was a narrow victory, but it was enough and work commenced on the projects the following Spring.

Two of the projects on the list were ones that directly affect our neighborhood. Most of the problems with the Calabazas Creek were fixed some years ago without need to use the bond money, North Sunnyvale still had two problem areas, though. One is the Sunnyvale West Channel which flows through the "Orchard Gardens" neighborhood west of us. The other is the Sunnyvale East Channel, which forms the western border of Lakewood Village.
(cont. page 2)

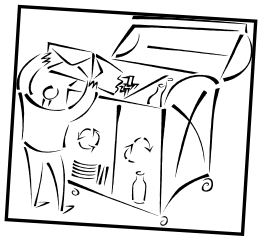
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Dumpster Day, Picnic, and Parade

-Fred Fowler

Hello neighbors. The nice Summer weather is finally here and the sun seems to be shining brightly on our neighborhood. It is shining brightly on the LVNA as well! After a few years of declining activity the LVNA seems to be "firing on all cylinders". We started off with a record breaking parade last December and followed up with a highly successful *Dumpster Day* last month. We're catching our breath a bit in August, but come September it will be time to stage our annual picnic. Not long after that we'll be in "parade mode" again. They say time flies when you are having fun, and this LVNA year is flying by!



DUMPSTER DAY

July 17th was *Dumpster Day*, and once again everything went very smoothly. **Specialty Waste** delivered all of the debris boxes on Friday and by Saturday afternoon we had cleaned more than **100 tons of trash, refuse and junk** out of the neighborhood. There were a few glitches (such as the breakdown of one of Specialty Waste's trucks), but overall it was another event for the record books.

There were lots of volunteers involved and there isn't room to thank them all here. I would like to give some special recognition to a few who stand out in my mind.



The first I want to thank are the friends and family of **Jim and Helen Lane.** Jim was one of the mainstays of Dumpster Day for many years and took on the role of organizing the entire event more than once. Unfortunately Jim is no longer with us. The neighborhood lost Jim sometime back, and it felt very strange for me to work through a *Dumpster Day* without him. He presence was felt though, at the dumpster that was delivered to its usual place in front of the Lane's house. **Helen Lane**, her daughter and their neighbors took care of it and made sure it was available for the people in the southeast corner of *Lakewood Village*. Many thanks to them for keeping up the tradition.

The next set of volunteers I want to thank are **Sarah Daugherty and her daughter**. Together they took care of two dumpsters in front of Sarah's home **(Continued on page 2)**

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(August Meeting Cont. from page 1)

The reason I'm telling you all of this is that after ten years of waiting, work on the Sunnyvale East and Sunnyvale West channels is about to begin! It will cause some disruption to our neighborhood when the big earth moving equipment starts to work, but when the dust settles Lakewood Village will be much safer from storm caused flooding.

The **Santa Clara Valley Water District** wants to make a presentation to us about the upcoming projects so that we'll know what to expect. They want to apologize in advance for the noise, dust, and other disrupting things we'll be exposed to. They want to explain the benefits the revamped channels will bring to Lakewood Village in terms of safety ad security. They've requested time during our August meeting to make the presentation.

Please come to the **Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, August 11th at 7:00pm** to hear the Santa Clara Valley Water District presentation on the upcoming flood control projects. Bring your questions with you! There will be several representatives of the Water District there to make sure all of them get answered.

It is very gracious of the Water District to go to the trouble of sending these people to explain the projects to us. Let's give them a good turnout in return! Let's show them that our neighborhood cares about what goes on around us and appreciates it when someone stretches out a hand in friendship. Lets take that hand, listen to what they have to say and show them that we care. We'll all be glad that we did. ◆

(***Dumpster Day Continued from page 1)***



on the west side of the village. Once again those two dumpsters had stood there many times before, and in years past Sarah's late husband Jim Daugherty had seen to it that everything went smoothly. Jim is sorely missed, but once again thanks to Sarah and her family, his spirit is not forgotten. We all owe them a debt of thanks.

The final volunteer I want to recognize is the LVNA 2nd Vice President **Skip Gottschalk**. Not only did he and his wife **Annie** watch two dumpsters on Fairwood avenue, Skip took on the huge challenge of organizing the entire event this year. He made phone calls to recruit volunteers, he met with city officials and he drove around the neighborhood on *Dumpster Day* itself collecting goods for the yard sale. Without him, *Dumpster Day* would not have happened this year. **(Continued on page 3)**

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(***Dumpster Day Continued)***

Many thanks to him. He made the job look easy!

One more thing. This year we had many generous donations that we took to the Shell station and sold as part of a yard sale. The things that sold included a washer/dryer combo, a large nearly new refrigerator and a big screen TV! **Bev Woidyla** (our Treasurer) reported that we took in more than double the money this year than we did last year. The total amount was **$428!** That is enough to pay for the printing of our newsletter for one month. Thanks to everyone who contributed something to the sale. It all made a big difference for us.

PICNIC TIME

Now that Dumpster Day is over it is time to start serious preparations for our annual picnic. We've set the date **(September 25th)** and we've reserved the picnic area. All we need to do now is get the food together and figure out how to cook it. In years past the LVNA has gone to various businesses and asked them to donate the food we've needed. We found many of them to be very generous and have fed up to 300 people at our picnics entirely with donated food. The **Lion and Compass** restaurant on Fair Oaks once donated all the hamburger we used (35 pounds of it), an **New York Style Italian Sausage Company** off Tasman Avenue donated a whole case of delicious sausage, and **Coco's** on Lawrence and Oakmead donated half a dozen of their pies. **Armadillo Willy's** used to give us a selection of meats and side dishes. Black Angus gave us gift certificates to raffle off as door prizes. Even some of our business friends that are not in the food industry donated things "pot luck" style. **Lakewood Dental** (one of our long time supporters and newsletter advertisers) once donated a large quantity of absolutely fabulous marinated chicken (it was a secret family recipe). The list goes on and on.



When it is at its best, the annual picnic is an exercise in making *"stone soup*." We ask everyone involved to bring their own contribution to the feast. It doesn't matter if the contribution is large or small. All that matters is that it is heartfelt. It is all about neighbors working together a unique and special meal that everyone can share.

I'm sure that the picnic will be a great success again this year. There is only one problem we have to solve. We need to find someone to take responsibility for making it happen! As I said, we have the date and the picnic area. All we need is someone to coordinate the solicitation of donations, figure out where we can store it all, and then get some cooks and other helpers together. Things will all have to be set up on the morning of the 25th, the food cooked and served, and then the picnic area will have to be cleaned up afterward. **(Continued next column)**

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(cont.) There are many longtime LVNA volunteers who have been through the drill many times before. We just need one person to take the lead.

Please think it over, and then give me a call. Call me at (408) 505-2813 and let me know that you will perform this service for your neighbors. Don't worry about not knowing what to do – there are plenty of experienced "old hands" who can show you the ropes. All that is needed is a positive attitude, some spare time and a determination to succeed. With those three things, there is no way you can fail.

Thanks in advance, whoever you are!

PARADE PREPARATIONS



I know that it is August, and the last thing that comes to mind is the Christmas season right now. When it is 90 degrees outside and the weather is lovely, who wants to think about a cold December day when 40+ different groups will parade from the Lakewood School to the Fairwood park?

Unfortunately, it is NOT too soon to start thinking about how to organize the 2010 Lakewood Village Holiday Parade. Schedules and calendars for potential parade participants start filling up at this time of the year, and if we want to invite some more "celebrity" entrants, we'd better get busy now! **(Continued on page 5)**

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Sunnyvale Music Series

The Summer Music & Market on Wednesdays and the Sunnyvale Jazz & Beyond Series are coming to a close this month. Don't miss the exciting and marvelous live music playing on Historic Murphy Avenue. If you haven't visited the 100 block of Murphy Avenue since its reopening, your in for a treat!

Wednesday Summer Music & Market

Come for the live music, great food and a market of arts and craft vendors.

Aug. 18 Native Elements (reggae)
Aug 25 Pacific Standard Time (70's funk/r & B)
Sept. 1 The Hitmen (rhythm & blues)

Sunnyvale Jazz & Beyond Series

On Saturday nights, Murphy Avenue is closed and you can order dinner in the street at your table while listening to excellent free live jazz music. The dinner menu has selections from each of the downtown restaurants. (Sunset magazine suggest that you bring a cell phone to place your order.)

Aug 14 Kaye Bohler (blues/jazz)
Aug 21 Tony Lindsay with Tom Politzer (r & b & contemporary jazz)
Aug 28 Jeff Bordes & The Jazz Desperados (jazz-funk)

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(Parade Preparations
Continued from page 3)



One thing I've wanted for many years is to have more than one marching band in the parade. The Fremont High School Band has done a wonderful job for us for many years, and the date of the parade is actually set by their schedule. The Columbia Middle School Band has joined forces with them to provide a bigger group and a louder sound. They are the highlight of the parade, and they always lead the way down Lakechime, Meadowlake, Lakehaven and Sandia. The trouble is that once they've passed by the parade gets very quiet. I would love to have one band at the front of the parade and another bringing up the rear. In order to accomplish this, someone has to start contacting local schools to see if we can be fit into their calendar. The time to do so is now, as once school starts it will probably be too late.

In 1996 our parade almost didn't take place. No one stepped forward to organize it and I wrote an article in *the Villager* saying that perhaps the parade was no longer important enough justify all of the effort. A few days after the newsletter was published I got a call from a young mother with a 5 month old child. She said that she would take on the challenge and make the parade happen because she wanted her child to have the chance to see parades when he grew up. She took on the challenge and made the parade a great success! Her name was Nan Dorio, and she received a special commendation from the Mayor of Sunnyvale for her efforts. If Nan could make a success of the parade while caring for a new baby, then why couldn't you? What is holding you back? Please give me a call at (408) 505-2813 and let me know who you are. Once again, there is no need to wonder what to do – the LVNA has been staging the parade for more than 30 years and we have a large crew of experiences helpers. All you have to do is step forward. We'll show you how to do the rest...

That's all for this month. Have a pleasant August, everyone! I'll see you at the picnic! ◆

Retired Del Monte, Shuckels and Libby Workers Wanted

The **Sunnyvale Historical Society and Museum** is looking for anyone who worked the "minors line" or seasonal fruit lines of local Canneries for a special reception planned in their honor. The retired Sunnyvale Cannery Workers celebrations is scheduled for **August 17th, 1:30—3:30 pm at the Heritage Park Museum, 570 East Remington Drive.** During the event, artifacts, photos and other memorabilia will be on display in addition to the permanent cannery exhibit. For more information, call (408) 749-0220.
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LVNA Contacts:

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Editorial Deadline for next month's Newsletter: by August 27th

To contact the editor, Please call Phyllis Fowler at (408)747-1454 or email phyllis@fmfa.com

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